

ROSE HIPS

(*Rosa canina*)

Found in hedgerows in most parts of the world, the best rose hips come from the wild rose, but many other effective varieties are available. Most health food stores and tea stores stock them. Rose hips contain very high amounts of vitamin C, antioxidants, and carotenoids, and are known to relieve the symptoms of cold and flu, headaches, and indigestion. They also provide nourishment to the skin because of their high antioxidant and bioflavonoid content. Their anti-inflammatory properties can help relieve arthritic swelling.



CARDAMOM

(*Elettaria cardamomum*)

Native to southeast Asia, the leaves of the cardamom plant can grow up to 10ft (3m) tall. Its seed pods contain small black seeds that should be crushed before adding to tisanes. Cardamom aids digestion and helps treat the symptoms of colds and flu. It also acts as a natural diuretic and antioxidant, and has detoxifying and anti-inflammatory benefits.



FENNEL

(*Foeniculum vulgare*)

Fennel, with its licorice flavor, primarily aids digestion, and so is suitable as an after-dinner tisane. The seeds contain quercetin, the flavonoid antioxidant that has immune-boosting benefits. The anti-inflammatory properties of quercetin can help to relieve symptoms of arthritis.



Fennel